

But Shree doesn't do her homework. Instead, she starts the computer, goes online and waits for her new friend to ping her. Soon she gets a message from Chaitra.

"Hello, friend. How are you today?"

"I'm fine, I didn't eat my tiffin," types Shree. "Why?" types Chaitra.

"Because I wanted to talk to you. So I finished tea quickly," types Shree.

"Great. Now can you send me a selfie? And give me your number so I can call you," types Chaitra.

"I don't have a camera phone," types Shree and feels sad.

Chaitra offers to give Shree her old camera phone.

"Let us meet on Sunday. Then I will take your snap. And give you my old phone."

Shree has always wished for a phone with a camera. She types, "Where shall we meet?"

Chaitra types, "Come to the railway station." Shree asks, "What time?"

Chaitra decides, "When the Bengaluru train reaches there."

Akka comes into the room just then to clean it.

"What are you doing, Shree?"

"I have a new friend, Akka!" Akka looks over Shree's shoulder at Chaitra's profile picture.

"But that's the film actress Madhoo. Is she your friend?"

"Yes, but her name is Chaitra."

Akka laughs and shakes her head. "That's Madhoo, I've seen all her films. She must be so old now." "She's the same age as me!" insists Shree.

"No, no, she's as old as I am," says Akka. "That snap was taken when she was still in school. It is from her first movie."

Shree is angry with Akka, then stops to think. Is Chaitra using someone else's picture—a film star's? "How old are you?" she types.

"I told you I'm thirteen, the same age as you," Chaitra types back.

Shree replies, "That is good. Best friends should be the same age." "Hey, the earrings in your profile picture are so pretty!" types Shree.

"Thanks, I made them myself."

"Wow. Wear them when we meet tomorrow!" "Okay, but only if you come alone," says Chaitra.

"Why?" types Shree.

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